

# 2008text3

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## 中文主旨

本文以NBA球员身高变化为引子，指出美国人的平均身高自20世纪60年代初以来已基本停止增长，分析了身高增长的必要条件（营养与健康）以及人类身高存在遗传上限的原因，并说明这一趋势在近期不会改变。

## 英文主旨

Taking the height change of NBA players as an introduction, this article points out that the average height of Americans has basically stopped growing since the early 1960s, analyzes the necessary conditions for height growth (nutrition and health) and the reasons for the genetic limit of human height, and states that this trend will not change in the near future.

## 逐句翻译与解析

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### 第一段

① In the early 1960s Wilt Chamberlain was one of the only three players in the National Basketball Association (NBA) listed at over seven feet.

翻译：20世纪60年代初，威尔特·张伯伦是美国职业篮球联赛（NBA）中仅有的三名身高超过7英尺的球员之一。

#### 常考单词短语

- list /lɪst/ v. 把...列入名单；列举
- over seven feet 超过7英尺（约2.13米）
- National Basketball Association (NBA) 美国职业篮球联赛

② If he had played last season, however, he would have been one of 42.

翻译：然而，如果他上个赛季还在打球，他就会是42名这样的球员之一。

#### 常考单词短语

- last season 上个赛季

#### 长难句分析

这是对过去情况的虚拟条件句，从句谓语用 **had done** 结构，主句谓语用 **would have done** 结构。

③ The bodies playing major professional sports have changed dramatically over the years, and managers have been more than willing to adjust team uniforms to fit the growing numbers of bigger, longer frames.

翻译：多年来，参加主流职业体育运动的运动员的身材发生了巨大变化，而且球队管理者们非常乐意调整队服，以适应越来越多身材更高大、体型更修长的运动员。

#### 常考单词短语

- major /'meɪdʒə(r)/ adj. 主要的；重要的
- professional /prə'feʃənəl/ adj. 职业的；专业的
- dramatically /drə'mætrɪkli/ adv. 显著地；戏剧性地
- more than willing 非常乐意

- adjust /ə'dʒʌst/ v. 调整；调节
- uniform /'ju:nɪfɔ:m/ n. 制服；队服
- fit /fɪt/ v. 适合；合身
- frame /freɪm/ n. 身材；骨架

### 长难句分析

并列句，由 and 连接两个分句。第一个分句中，playing major professional sports 是现在分词短语作后置定语，修饰 The bodies；第二个分句中，to fit the growing numbers of bigger, longer frames 是不定式短语作目的状语。

## 第二段

① The trend in sports, though, may be obscuring an unrecognized reality: Americans have generally stopped growing.

翻译：然而，体育界的这种趋势可能掩盖了一个未被人们认识到的事实：美国人的身高总体上已经停止增长了。

### 常考单词短语

- trend /trend/ n. 趋势；倾向
- obscure /əb'skjuə(r)/ v. 掩盖；使模糊
- unrecognized /ʌn'rekənaɪzd/ adj. 未被认识到的；未被承认的
- generally /'dʒenrəli/ adv. 总体上；通常

② Though typically about two inches taller now than 140 years ago, today's people — especially those born to families who have lived in the U.S. for many generations — apparently reached their limit in the early 1960s.

翻译：尽管现在的人比140年前的人普遍高约2英寸，但他们——尤其是那些出生在已在美国生活了好几代的家庭的人——显然在20世纪60年代初就已经达到了身高的极限。

### 常考单词短语

- typically /'tɪpɪkli/ adv. 通常；典型地
- inch /ɪntʃ/ n. 英寸（约2.54厘米）
- generation /,dʒenə'reɪʃn/ n. 代；一代
- apparently /ə'pærəntli/ adv. 显然地；明显地
- limit /'lɪmɪt/ n. 极限；限制

### 长难句分析

主从复合句。Though 引导让步状语从句，从句中省略了主语和be动词（they are）；两个破折号之间的部分是插入语，对 today's people 进行补充说明，其中 who 引导定语从句修饰 families。

③ And they aren't likely to get any taller.

翻译：而且他们不太可能再长高了。

### 常考单词短语

- be likely to do sth. 可能做某事

④ “In the general population today, at this genetic, environmental level, we've pretty much gone as far as we can go,” says anthropologist William Cameron Chumlea of Wright State University.

翻译：莱特州立大学的人类学家威廉·卡梅伦·查姆利说：“如今，就普通人群而言，在现有的基因和环境水平下，我们的身高已经差不多达到了极限。”

### 常考单词短语

- general population 普通人群
  - genetic /dʒə'netɪk/ adj. 基因的；遗传的
  - environmental /ɪnˌvaɪrən'mentl/ adj. 环境的
  - pretty much 几乎；差不多
  - anthropologist /ˌænθrə'pɒlədʒɪst/ n. 人类学家
- 

⑤ In the case of NBA players, their increase in height appears to result from the increasingly common practice of recruiting players from all over the world.

翻译：至于NBA球员，他们身高的增长似乎是由于从全球招募球员这一做法变得越来越普遍。

### 常考单词短语

- in the case of 至于；就...而言
- result from 由...导致；起因于
- increasingly /ɪn'kri:sɪŋli/ adv. 越来越多地；日益
- practice /'præktɪs/ n. 做法；惯例
- recruit /rɪ'kru:t/ v. 招募；招聘
- all over the world 全世界

## 第三段

① Growth, which rarely continues beyond the age of 20, demands calories and nutrients — notably, protein — to feed expanding tissues.

翻译：身高增长很少会持续到20岁以后，它需要卡路里和营养物质——尤其是蛋白质——来供给不断生长的组织。

### 常考单词短语

- rarely /'reəli/ adv. 很少；难得
- demand /dɪ'mænd/ v. 需要；要求
- calorie /'kæləri/ n. 卡路里（热量单位）
- nutrient /'nju:triənt/ n. 营养物；营养品
- notably /'nəʊtəbli/ adv. 尤其；特别
- protein /'prəʊti:n/ n. 蛋白质
- feed /fi:d/ v. 供给；喂养
- expand /ɪk'spænd/ v. 扩张；生长
- tissue /'tɪʃu:/ n. 组织

### 长难句分析

主从复合句。which 引导非限制性定语从句，修饰 Growth；两个破折号之间的部分是插入语，对 nutrients 进行举例说明。

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② At the start of the 20th century, under-nutrition and childhood infections got in the way.

翻译：20世纪初，营养不良和儿童期传染病阻碍了身高的增长。

### 常考单词短语

- at the start of 在...开始时
  - under-nutrition /ˌʌndə nju:'trɪʃn/ n. 营养不良
  - childhood /'tʃaɪldhʊd/ n. 童年；儿童时期
  - infection /ɪn'fekʃn/ n. 传染病；感染
  - get in the way 妨碍；阻碍
-

③ But as diet and health improved, children and adolescents have, on average, increased in height by about an inch and a half every 20 years, a pattern known as the secular trend in height.  
翻译：但随着饮食和健康状况的改善，儿童和青少年的平均身高每20年增长约1.5英寸，这种模式被称为身高的长期趋势。

#### 常考单词短语

- diet /'daɪət/ n. 饮食
- adolescent /,ædə'lesnt/ n. 青少年
- on average 平均
- pattern /'pætn/ n. 模式；方式
- secular /'sekjələ(r)/ adj. 长期的；世俗的

#### 长难句分析

主从复合句。as 引导时间状语从句；主句中，on average 是插入语；a pattern known as the secular trend in height 是同位语，对前面整个主句的内容进行解释说明，其中 known as... 是过去分词短语作后置定语修饰 a pattern。

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④ Yet according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, average height — 5'9" for men, 5'4" for women — hasn't really changed since 1960.

翻译：然而，根据美国疾病控制与预防中心的数据，男性平均身高5英尺9英寸（约1.75米）、女性平均身高5英尺4英寸（约1.63米），自1960年以来实际上没有变化。

#### 常考单词短语

- according to 根据；按照
- the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) 美国疾病控制与预防中心

## 第四段

① Genetically speaking, there are advantages to avoiding substantial height.

翻译：从遗传学角度来说，避免身高过高是有好处的。

#### 常考单词短语

- genetically /dʒə'netɪkli/ adv. 从遗传学角度；基因上
  - advantage /əd'vɑ:ntɪdʒ/ n. 优势；好处
  - substantial /səb'stænʃl/ adj. 大量的；重大的
- 

② During childbirth, larger babies have more difficulty passing through the birth canal.

翻译：分娩时，体型较大的婴儿更难通过产道。

#### 常考单词短语

- childbirth /'tʃaɪldbɜ:θ/ n. 分娩；生产
  - have difficulty (in) doing sth. 做某事有困难
  - pass through 通过；穿过
  - birth canal 产道
- 

③ Moreover, even though humans have been upright for millions of years, our feet and back continue to struggle with bipedal posture and cannot easily withstand repeated strain imposed by oversized limbs.

翻译：此外，尽管人类已经直立行走了数百万年，我们的双脚和背部仍在艰难地适应两足行走的姿势，无法轻易承受过大的四肢带来的持续压力。

## 常考单词短语

- moreover /məʊr'əʊvə(r)/ adv. 此外；而且
- upright /'ʌpraɪt/ adj. 直立的；垂直的
- struggle with 与...作斗争；艰难应对
- bipedal /ˌbaɪ'pi:dl/ adj. 两足的；两足动物的
- posture /'pɒstʃə(r)/ n. 姿势；体态
- withstand /wɪð'stænd/ v. 承受；抵挡
- repeated /rɪ'pi:tɪd/ adj. 反复的；重复的
- strain /streɪn/ n. 压力；拉力
- impose /ɪm'pəʊz/ v. 强加；施加
- oversize /'əʊvə'saɪz/ adj. 过大的；超大的
- limb /lɪm/ n. 四肢；肢体

## 长难句分析

主从复合句。even though 引导让步状语从句；主句有两个并列的谓语部分：continue to struggle with bipedal posture 和 cannot easily withstand repeated strain imposed by oversize limbs；其中 imposed by oversize limbs 是过去分词短语作后置定语，修饰 repeated strain。

④ “There are some real constraints that are set by the genetic architecture of the individual organism,” says anthropologist William Leonard of Northwestern University.

翻译：西北大学的人类学家威廉·伦纳德说：“个体有机体的基因结构设定了一些真正的限制。”

## 常考单词短语

- constraint /kən'streɪnt/ n. 限制；约束
- set /set/ v. 设定；设置
- genetic architecture 基因结构
- individual /ˌɪndɪ'vɪdʒuəl/ adj. 个体的；个人的
- organism /'ɔ:ɡənɪzəm/ n. 有机体；生物体

## 长难句分析

主从复合句。that 引导定语从句，修饰 constraints。

## 第五段

① Genetic maximums can change, but don't expect this to happen soon.

翻译：基因的最大值可以改变，但不要指望这会很快发生。

## 常考单词短语

- maximum /'mæksɪmə/ n. 最大值；极限

② Claire C. Gordon, senior anthropologist at the Army Research Center in Natick, Mass., ensures that 90 percent of the uniforms and workstations fit recruits without alteration.

翻译：马萨诸塞州纳蒂克陆军研究中心的资深人类学家克莱尔·C·戈登证实，90%的制服和工作站无需改动就能适合新兵。

## 常考单词短语

- senior /'si:nɪə(r)/ adj. 资深的；高级的
- ensure /ɪn'ʃʊə(r)/ v. 确保；保证
- workstation /'wɜ:ksteɪʃn/ n. 工作站
- recruit /rɪ'kru:t/ n. 新兵；新成员
- alteration /ˌɔ:lteɪ'reɪʃn/ n. 改动；变更

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③ She says that, unlike those for basketball, the length of military uniforms has not changed for some time.

翻译：她说，与篮球服不同，军装的长度已经有一段时间没有改变了。

#### 常考单词短语

- unlike /ˌʌnˈlaɪk/ prep. 不像；与...不同
- military /ˈmɪlətri/ adj. 军事的；军队的
- length /leŋθ/ n. 长度

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④ And if you need to predict human height in the near future to design a piece of equipment, Gordon says that by and large, “you could use today's data and feel fairly confident.”

翻译：戈登说，如果你需要预测不久的将来人类的身高来设计一款设备，总的来说，“你可以放心地使用现在的数据。”

#### 常考单词短语

- predict /prɪˈdɪkt/ v. 预测；预言
- in the near future 在不久的将来
- equipment /ɪˈkwɪpmənt/ n. 设备；装备
- by and large 总的来说；大体上
- data /ˈdeɪtə/ n. 数据；资料
- fairly /ˈfeəli/ adv. 相当地；公平地
- confident /ˈkɒnfɪdənt/ adj. 自信的；有信心的

## 完整原文

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In the early 1960s Wilt Chamberlain was one of the only three players in the National Basketball Association (NBA) listed at over seven feet. If he had played last season, however, he would have been one of 42. The bodies playing major professional sports have changed dramatically over the years, and managers have been more than willing to adjust team uniforms to fit the growing numbers of bigger, longer frames.

The trend in sports, though, may be obscuring an unrecognized reality: Americans have generally stopped growing. Though typically about two inches taller now than 140 years ago, today's people — especially those born to families who have lived in the U.S. for many generations — apparently reached their limit in the early 1960s. And they aren't likely to get any taller. “In the general population today, at this genetic, environmental level, we've pretty much gone as far as we can go,” says anthropologist William Cameron Chumlea of Wright State University. In the case of NBA players, their increase in height appears to result from the increasingly common practice of recruiting players from all over the world.

Growth, which rarely continues beyond the age of 20, demands calories and nutrients — notably, protein — to feed expanding tissues. At the start of the 20th century, under-nutrition and childhood infections got in the way. But as diet and health improved, children and adolescents have, on average, increased in height by about an inch and a half every 20 years, a pattern known as the secular trend in height. Yet according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, average height — 5'9" for men, 5'4" for women — hasn't really changed since 1960.

Genetically speaking, there are advantages to avoiding substantial height. During childbirth, larger babies have more difficulty passing through the birth canal. Moreover, even though humans have been upright for millions of years, our feet and back continue to struggle with bipedal posture and cannot easily withstand repeated strain imposed by oversize limbs. “There are some real

constraints that are set by the genetic architecture of the individual organism,” says anthropologist William Leonard of Northwestern University.

Genetic maximums can change, but don't expect this to happen soon. Claire C. Gordon, senior anthropologist at the Army Research Center in Natick, Mass., ensures that 90 percent of the uniforms and workstations fit recruits without alteration. She says that, unlike those for basketball, the length of military uniforms has not changed for some time. And if you need to predict human height in the near future to design a piece of equipment, Gordon says that by and large, “you could use today's data and feel fairly confident.”

## 完整翻译

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20世纪60年代初，威尔特·张伯伦是美国职业篮球联赛（NBA）中仅有的三名身高超过7英尺的球员之一。然而，如果他上个赛季还在打球，他就会是42名这样的球员之一。多年来，参加主流职业体育运动的运动员的身材发生了巨大变化，而且球队管理者们非常乐意调整队服，以适应越来越多身材更高大、体型更修长的运动员。

然而，体育界的这种趋势可能掩盖了一个未被人们认识到的事实：美国人的身高总体上已经停止增长了。尽管现在的人比140年前的人普遍高约2英寸，但他们——尤其是那些出生在已在美国生活了好几代的家庭的人——显然在20世纪60年代初就已经达到了身高的极限。而且他们不太可能再长高了。莱特州立大学的人类学家威廉·卡梅伦·查姆利说：“如今，就普通人群而言，在现有的基因和环境水平下，我们的身高已经差不多达到了极限。”至于NBA球员，他们身高的增长似乎是由于从全球招募球员这一做法变得越来越普遍。

身高增长很少会持续到20岁以后，它需要卡路里和营养物质——尤其是蛋白质——来供给不断生长的组织。20世纪初，营养不良和儿童期传染病阻碍了身高的增长。但随着饮食和健康状况的改善，儿童和青少年的平均身高每20年增长约1.5英寸，这种模式被称为身高的长期趋势。然而，根据美国疾病控制与预防中心的数据，男性平均身高5英尺9英寸（约1.75米）、女性平均身高5英尺4英寸（约1.63米），自1960年以来实际上没有变化。

从遗传学角度来说，避免身高过高是有好处的。分娩时，体型较大的婴儿更难通过产道。此外，尽管人类已经直立行走了数百万年，但我们的双脚和背部仍在艰难地适应两足行走的姿势，无法轻易承受过大的四肢带来的持续压力。西北大学的人类学家威廉·伦纳德说：“个体有机体的基因结构设定了一些真正的限制。”

基因的最大值可以改变，但不要指望这会很快发生。马萨诸塞州纳蒂克陆军研究中心的资深人类学家克莱尔·C·戈登证实，90%的制服和工作站无需改动就能适合新兵。她说，与篮球服不同，军装的长度已经有一段时间没有改变了。戈登说，如果你需要预测不久的将来人类的身高来设计一款设备，总的来说，“你可以放心地使用现在的数据。”